

ShopEase

Customer Support Guide

Version 2.1 | Effective: January 2025 | For Customer & Agent Use

1. Introduction

ShopEase is an online retail platform offering a wide range of products including electronics, fashion, home essentials, and personal care items. Founded in 2018, ShopEase serves over 4 million customers across India, with same-day delivery available in 12 major cities and standard delivery across 25,000+ pin codes.

This document serves as the official Customer Support Guide for both end customers and internal support agents. It outlines ShopEase's policies on refunds, returns, shipping, payments, order management, and complaint resolution. All policies in this guide are current as of January 2025 and supersede any previously published versions.

Note: Some policies may vary for third-party sellers listed on the ShopEase marketplace. In such cases, customers should refer to the seller's individual store policy page.

2. Refund Policy

2.1 Eligibility Criteria

A refund request is considered valid when one or more of the following conditions are met:

- The item delivered is defective or damaged upon arrival.
- The customer received an incorrect product (different from what was ordered).
- The package was not delivered within the promised delivery window and the customer requests cancellation.
- The item was returned in its original condition within the permitted return window (see Section 3).
- A duplicate payment was charged for the same order.

2.2 Time Limits

Refund requests must be raised within the following timeframes from the date of delivery:

- Defective or damaged products: within 48 hours of delivery.
- Wrong item received: within 48 hours of delivery.
- General returns (change of mind, size issues, etc.): within 7 days of delivery.

- Late delivery cancellations: before the shipment is marked as delivered.

Requests submitted after these deadlines may be reviewed on a case-by-case basis by the ShopEase Customer Relations team. No guarantees are made for late requests.

2.3 Refund Processing Time

Once a return is received and inspected at the ShopEase fulfillment center, refunds are processed within the following timelines:

- UPI / Net Banking / Debit Card: 3 to 5 business days.
- Credit Card: 5 to 7 business days (depending on the issuing bank).
- ShopEase Wallet Credits: within 24 hours of return approval.
- Cash on Delivery (COD) orders: refunded to the customer's registered bank account via NEFT within 7 business days.

2.4 Exceptions — Items Not Eligible for Refund

- Perishable goods such as food items, flowers, and fresh produce.
- Digital products including software licenses, e-books, and subscription codes once redeemed.
- Intimate or hygiene products (undergarments, earrings, face masks) once opened.
- Customised or personalised products made to order.
- Items explicitly marked as 'Non-Refundable' on the product listing page.

3. Return Policy

3.1 Conditions for Return

ShopEase accepts returns only when all of the following conditions are satisfied:

- The item is unused, unwashed, and in its original condition.
- All original tags, labels, and packaging materials are intact.
- The return request is raised within 7 days of the delivery date.
- The item is accompanied by the original invoice or order confirmation.
- The product belongs to a returnable category (see Section 3.3).

3.2 Steps to Initiate a Return

- Step 1: Log in to your ShopEase account and navigate to 'My Orders'.
- Step 2: Select the order and click 'Return / Exchange'.
- Step 3: Choose the reason for return and upload supporting photos if the item is damaged or incorrect.
- Step 4: Select your preferred pickup slot. A ShopEase logistics partner will collect the item.
- Step 5: Once the item is picked up and quality-checked, your refund or exchange will be processed.

Self-ship returns: For certain pin codes where pickup is unavailable, customers may be asked to ship the item to our returns center. Shipping charges up to Rs. 150 will be reimbursed via ShopEase Wallet.

3.3 Non-Returnable Items

- Consumables: batteries, printer cartridges, and similar items once opened.
 - Beauty and skincare products once the seal is broken.
 - Software, games, and digital media once activated or downloaded.
 - Furniture and large appliances after installation (unless defective).
 - Jewellery without original certificates or if the security tag is removed.
 - Products purchased under 'Final Sale' or 'Clearance' labels.
-

4. Shipping Information

4.1 Delivery Timelines

- Same-Day Delivery: Available in Bengaluru, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Hyderabad, Chennai, Pune, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Surat, Lucknow, and Chandigarh. Orders must be placed before 11:00 AM.
- Express Delivery (Next Day): Available across 500+ cities. Orders placed before 6:00 PM qualify.
- Standard Delivery: 3 to 5 business days for most pin codes. Remote areas may require 6 to 8 days.
- Heavy / Bulky Items: 5 to 10 business days due to special handling requirements.

4.2 Shipping Charges

- Free standard shipping on all orders above Rs. 499.
- Orders below Rs. 499: flat shipping fee of Rs. 49.
- Express delivery: Rs. 99 surcharge regardless of order value.
- Same-day delivery: Rs. 149 surcharge. Available to ShopEase Plus members at Rs. 79.

4.3 Delays and Handling

ShopEase strives to deliver all orders within the promised window. However, delays may occur due to factors beyond our control, including severe weather conditions, public holidays, logistics partner disruptions, or natural calamities. In such situations:

- The customer will be notified via SMS and email with an updated estimated delivery date.
- If the order is delayed by more than 3 days beyond the promised date, the customer is entitled to a free Express upgrade on their next order (coupon issued via email).
- If the customer no longer requires the delayed order, they may cancel it before delivery and receive a full refund.

4.4 Order Tracking

All orders are assigned a unique tracking ID once dispatched. Customers can track their shipment in the following ways:

- Via the ShopEase app or website under 'My Orders' > 'Track Shipment'.
- Using the courier partner's website with the AWB number provided in the dispatch email.
- By contacting ShopEase support and providing the Order ID.

5. Payment Methods

5.1 Supported Payment Options

- UPI: PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, BHIM UPI, and all other UPI-enabled apps.
- Credit Cards: Visa, Mastercard, RuPay, American Express, Diners Club.
- Debit Cards: All major Indian bank debit cards.
- Net Banking: 50+ banks supported including SBI, HDFC, ICICI, Axis, Kotak.
- ShopEase Wallet: Load and pay instantly. Eligible for exclusive cashback offers.
- EMI: No-cost EMI available on select products with partner banks for 3, 6, 9, and 12 months.
- Cash on Delivery (COD): Available for orders up to Rs. 10,000 in eligible pin codes.
- Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL): Available via ShopEase Pay Later for pre-approved users.

5.2 Payment Security

ShopEase is PCI DSS Level 1 compliant. All payment transactions are encrypted using 256-bit SSL/TLS protocols. ShopEase does not store card details on its servers. For added protection, all transactions above Rs. 5,000 may require an additional OTP or 3D Secure authentication as mandated by the Reserve Bank of India.

6. Order Cancellation

6.1 When Cancellation is Allowed

- Before dispatch: Orders can be cancelled anytime before the seller dispatches the item. Full refund is issued immediately.
- After dispatch but before delivery: Cancellation requests will be registered; the customer must refuse delivery at the door. Refund processed after item returns to warehouse.
- After delivery: Direct cancellation is not possible. Customer must raise a return request as per the Return Policy (Section 3).
- Pre-order and backorder items: Can be cancelled up to 24 hours before the confirmed dispatch date.

6.2 Refund Rules for Cancelled Orders

- Online payments (UPI, card, net banking): Full refund to the original payment source within 5 to 7 business days.
- COD orders cancelled before dispatch: No charge applied.
- COD orders refused at delivery: Rs. 50 handling fee may be deducted from future wallet credits.
- Promotional or discounted orders: Original discounts are forfeited upon cancellation; refund is for the amount paid only.

7. Customer Support

7.1 Contact Details

- Email: support@shopease.in — Response within 24 business hours.
- Phone: 1800-123-4567 (Toll-Free) — Available Monday to Saturday, 9:00 AM to 8:00 PM IST.
- Live Chat: Available on the ShopEase website and app, Monday to Sunday, 8:00 AM to 10:00 PM IST.
- Help Center: help.shopease.in — Self-service FAQs, guides, and policy documents.

7.2 Escalation Scenarios

The following situations are classified as priority escalations and will be handled by a Senior Customer Relations Executive within 4 business hours:

- Customer reports receiving a product that is significantly different from the listing (e.g., counterfeit suspicion).
- Refund not received within the stated processing window despite approval confirmation.
- Multiple failed delivery attempts without any customer notification.
- Billing or payment dispute involving a charge not initiated by the customer.
- Customer claims a safety hazard related to a product purchased from ShopEase.
- Any situation where the customer explicitly requests to speak with a senior agent or manager.

For cases involving legal notices, regulatory complaints, or media inquiries, please email legal@shopease.in directly. These are handled exclusively by the ShopEase Legal and Compliance team.

8. Special Scenarios

8.1 Damaged Product Received

If a customer receives a product that is visibly damaged — whether due to transit mishandling or a manufacturing defect — the following process applies:

- The customer must report the damage within 48 hours of delivery with clear photographs or a short video.
- ShopEase reserves the right to arrange an inspection visit before approving the claim in select cases.
- If the damage is confirmed, the customer will be offered: (a) a full replacement at no additional cost, or (b) a complete refund to the original payment source.
- If the customer has already used the product before noticing the damage, the resolution may vary. Such cases are escalated to the Customer Relations team for manual review.
- Products damaged due to customer misuse, improper storage, or accidental drops are not covered under this policy and will not qualify for a refund or replacement.

Ambiguous scenario: If the outer packaging is damaged but the product inside appears intact, the claim may be partially disputed. ShopEase will evaluate such cases based on photographic evidence and the product category.

8.2 Late Delivery

ShopEase guarantees delivery within the window communicated at the time of order. If an order is not delivered by the end of the promised date, the customer should:

- First check the tracking page for real-time shipment status.
- If the status shows 'Out for Delivery' but the item has not arrived by 9:00 PM, wait until the next morning before escalating.
- If there has been no update for over 48 hours, contact support immediately with the Order ID.
- Customers impacted by a delivery delay of more than 3 business days may request: (a) order cancellation with full refund, or (b) a goodwill discount coupon of Rs. 100 on their next purchase.

Ambiguous scenario: If the tracking shows 'Delivered' but the customer claims non-receipt, ShopEase will initiate a delivery verification with the logistics partner. Resolution timeline for such cases is 5 to 10 business days and is not guaranteed to result in a refund.

8.3 Wrong Item Received

If a customer receives an item that does not match their order (wrong size, colour, model, or an entirely different product), they should:

- Report the issue within 48 hours with a photograph of the received item and the original packaging label.
- ShopEase will arrange a reverse pickup and dispatch the correct item at no extra charge.
- If the correct item is out of stock, the customer will be offered a full refund.
- In cases where the wrong item received is of higher value than the ordered item, ShopEase may allow the customer to keep the item while still dispatching the correct one, subject to internal approval.

Ambiguous scenario: If the customer ordered a 'combo pack' and claims to have received only part of it, resolution depends on whether the seller listed it as a bundled shipment or separate items. This requires manual review and may take up to 7 business days.

Appendix: Sample Queries, Expected Answers & HITL Triggers

Part A — 10 Standard Queries with Expected Answers

Q1 What is the ShopEase refund policy for damaged products?

A: ShopEase accepts refund requests for damaged products if reported within 48 hours of delivery with photographic evidence. After inspection, customers can choose a full replacement or a complete refund to their original payment source.

Q2 How long does it take to receive a refund after returning an item?

A: Refund timelines vary by payment method: UPI and bank transfers take 3 to 5 business days, credit cards take 5 to 7 business days, and ShopEase Wallet credits are processed within 24 hours.

Q3 Can I return a product if I simply changed my mind?

A: Yes, ShopEase accepts returns within 7 days of delivery for change-of-mind reasons, provided the item is unused, in original packaging, with all tags intact, and belongs to a returnable category.

Q4 What are the delivery timelines for standard shipping?

A: Standard delivery takes 3 to 5 business days for most pin codes. Remote or rural areas may require 6 to 8 business days. Heavy or bulky items can take 5 to 10 business days.

Q5 What payment methods does ShopEase support?

A: ShopEase supports UPI (PhonePe, GPay, Paytm), credit and debit cards (Visa, Mastercard, RuPay), net banking (50+ banks), ShopEase Wallet, EMI, Cash on Delivery, and Buy Now Pay Later.

Q6 Can I cancel my order after it has been dispatched?

A: Yes, but the cancellation process differs. After dispatch, you must refuse delivery at the door. The refund is processed once the item returns to the warehouse. Direct cancellation is not possible post-delivery.

Q7 How do I track my ShopEase order?

A: You can track your order via the ShopEase app or website under 'My Orders' > 'Track Shipment', using the AWB number on the courier's website, or by contacting ShopEase support with your Order ID.

Q8 Are there any items that cannot be returned on ShopEase?

A: Yes. Non-returnable items include consumables once opened, beauty products with broken seals, digital goods once activated, jewellery without original certificates, furniture after installation (unless defective), and products marked as Final Sale.

Q9 How much does express delivery cost on ShopEase?

A: Express delivery (next-day) has a surcharge of Rs. 99 regardless of order value. Same-day delivery costs Rs. 149, or Rs. 79 for ShopEase Plus members.

Q10 What happens if my order is delayed beyond the promised delivery date?

A: ShopEase will notify you via SMS and email with an updated date. If the delay exceeds 3 business days, you are entitled to a free Express upgrade coupon on your next order, or you may cancel for a full refund.

Part B — 3 Queries That Should Trigger HITL Escalation

The following queries are intentionally complex, ambiguous, or involve sensitive billing and safety issues. A standard RAG chatbot should detect low confidence or policy ambiguity and escalate these to a human agent.

HITL-1 Ambiguous — Delivery conflict.

User: *My package shows 'Delivered' on the tracking page but I never received it. I live alone and was home all day. I want a refund immediately.*

Resolution Note: The tracking system shows delivery confirmation, but the customer disputes receipt. Per Section 8.2, ShopEase must initiate a delivery verification with the logistics partner, which takes 5 to 10 business days. A refund cannot be guaranteed. This requires manual investigation by the Customer Relations team and cannot be resolved by automated policy lookup alone. → Escalate to human agent.

HITL-2 Ambiguous — Bundled shipment dispute.

User: *I bought a combo pack of 3 items but only 2 arrived. The seller says all 3 were shipped together. Who is responsible and when will I get my third item or refund?*

Resolution Note: Per Section 8.3, resolution for combo pack partial delivery depends on whether the seller listed it as a bundled or split shipment. This requires checking seller-specific dispatch records and may take up to 7 business days. The chatbot cannot determine seller intent or access shipment manifests. → Escalate to human agent for manual review.

HITL-3 Sensitive — Counterfeit / fraud suspicion.

User: *I received a product that I suspect is counterfeit. The brand logo looks different, the packaging quality is poor, and it doesn't match the product photos on the listing. I paid Rs. 8,500 for this. I want immediate action.*

Resolution Note: Per Section 7.2, counterfeit suspicion is a priority escalation handled by a Senior Customer Relations Executive within 4 business hours. This cannot be resolved via chatbot as it may involve legal, seller verification, and quality audit processes. Additionally, the high order value (Rs. 8,500) and fraud implication require human accountability. → Immediately escalate to human agent.